

Alicia Wood

Product Design Leader

I'm a product design leader with over 15 years of experience spanning individual craft to design management in fintech. At Credit Karma, I progressed from Senior Product Designer to Senior Manager, Product Design in under four years, building and leading design teams, shaping product strategy with cross-functional leadership, and raising the bar on design craft. I combine strong systems thinking and DesignOps rigor with empathetic people first leadership. I've adopted and helped my team adopt AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Cursor) to accelerate design and team workflows.

Experience

Credit Karma Nov 2021 – Present · Charlotte, NC

Promoted multiple times in the span of four years for consistently elevating team performance and design quality. I managed and mentored a team of product designers, directing end-to-end design for Credit Karma banking products and Credit Karma connection to TurboTax from discovery through launch. I mentor designers, worked cross functionally with product, engineering, marketing, content designers, and analytics. I also contributed to design system standards and design operations adopted org-wide.

Senior Manager, Product Design Apr 2025 – Present

Product Design Manager II Apr 2024 – Apr 2025

Product Design Manager Dec 2022 – Apr 2024

Staff Product Designer Sep 2022 – Apr 2023

Senior Product Designer II May 2022 – Sep 2022

Senior Product Designer Nov 2021 – May 2022

Capital One Investing Jul 2020 – Oct 2021 · McLean, VA

Senior User Experience Designer

Led UX design for the Capital One Investing product, partnering with business SMEs, product, and engineering to solve business and user experience problems.

United Income Nov 2018 – Jul 2020 · Washington, DC

User Experience Designer

Led design projects end-to-end, from discovery through implementation, for a financial planning and investment platform, partnering cross-functionally on research to inform product decisions.

Early Career

User Experience Designer (Self-Employed) Apr 2016 – Nov 2018 · Remote

Technical Writer / Process Analyst (JPMorganChase) Jan 2017 – Jun 2018 · Wilmington, DE

Project Lead (CIBC) Jan 2014 – Dec 2016 · Toronto, ON

Technical Writer (CIBC) Dec 2010 – Jan 2014 · Toronto, ON

Web & Graphic Designer (Self-Employed) Jan 2011 – Dec 2014 · Toronto, ON

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Education

PM Masterclass for Designers Accelerate Design (Ryan Scott) · 2025

Describing the ROI of Design Accelerate Design (Ryan Scott) · 2025

Becoming a UX Strategist Nielsen Norman Group · 2023

Emerging Patterns in Interface Designs Nielsen Norman Group · 2022

Persuasive and Emotional Design Nielsen Norman Group · 2022

Customer Journey Management Nielsen Norman Group · 2022

DesignOps: Scaling UX Design and User Research Nielsen Norman Group · 2020

Behavioral Science for Practitioners Crash Course Ideas42 Academy · 2020

Six Sigma Green Belt McGill University · 2016

Foundations of Project Management University of Toronto · 2013

Technical Writing Humber College · 2013

Honours Bachelor of Arts, Communications & Professional Writing York University · 2010

Core Skills

- Design leadership
- Product & design strategy
- Hiring & talent development
- Coaching & mentorship
- Cross-functional leadership
- DesignOps
- Strategic decision-maker
- Member-centric
- Executive communicator

Tools

- Figma
- Claude
- ChatGPT (OpenAI)
- Perplexity
- Cursor
- Gemini
- Airtable
- JIRA
- Granola